Marine water prawn culture

The rearing of marine penaied prawn is called marine prawn culture or **shrimp culture.** *Penaeus indicus* and *Penaeus monodon* are cultured in marine water.

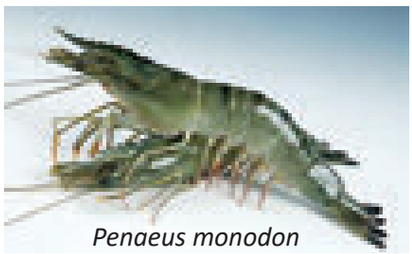


Figure 23.17 Marine water prawn

Freshwater prawn culture

The rearing of freshwater prawn is called freshwater prawn culture. *Macrobrachium rosenbergii* and *Macrobrachium malcomsonii* are cultured in freshwater.

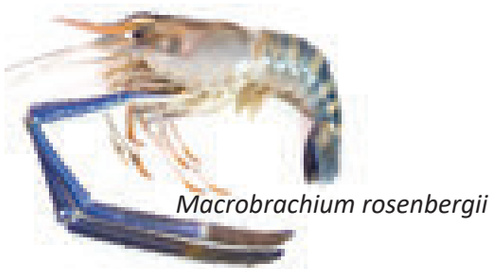


Figure 23.18 Freshwater prawn

23.12.2 Methods of Prawn Culture

The methods employed for prawn culture are:

a. Seed collection and hatchery method
b. Paddy cum prawn culture method

Seed collection and hatchery method

The larvae and juveniles obtained by collection from natural resources (estuaries, and backwaters) or by hatchery methods (controlled breeding). They are reared and grown into adults.



Figure 23.19 Post larvae (Prawn seed)

Paddy cum prawn culture

It is also called Pokkali culture. It is the oldest and traditional method of prawn culture practiced in Kerala. The low lying paddy fields along the coastal areas serve as suitable grounds for prawn culture. Prawns are cultured in these fields after the harvest of paddy.

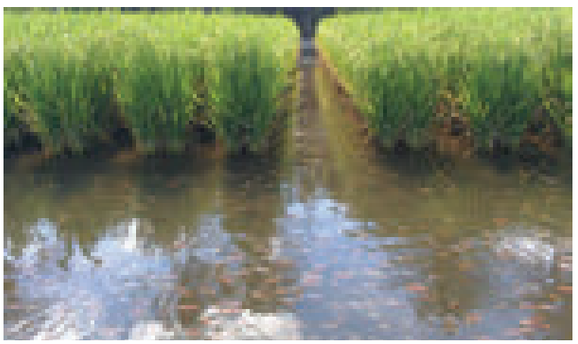


Figure 23.20 Paddy cum prawn/fish culture

23.13 Vermitechnology

The awareness of organic matter and concept of sustainable agriculture is gaining importance among our farmers in the recent years to produce good quality crops. Maintenance of soil organic matter is very important for sustainable productivity and this is attained by vermitechnology.

23.13.1 Vermiculture

Vermiculture involves the artificial rearing or cultivation of earthworms and using them for the production of compost from natural organic wastes.

Earthworm Species used for Vermiculture:

The earthworms used for vermicompost production are *Perionyx excavatus* (Indian blueworm), *Eisenia fetida* (Red worms), *Eudrilus eugeniae* (African night crawler).

23.13.2 Vermicomposting

It is an important component of organic farming which can convert bio-wastes into nutrient rich organic manure by using earthworms. It feeds on the organic wastes

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